

AHMED ZAYEEF

PhD Candidate • Information and Media
School of Journalism • Michigan State University
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Thematic Area 1: How journalists negotiate professional roles, norms, and values in everyday practice — the central question of my dissertation, which develops negotiation as an integrating framework for journalism studies

Keywords: *journalistic roles, norm negotiation, hierarchy of influences, boundary work*

Thematic Area 2: Journalism under political constraint — grounded in my decade as an investigative reporter in Bangladesh, examining press freedom, community embeddedness, and journalistic practice in authoritarian and transitional media systems

Keywords: *press freedom, authoritarian media systems, embeddedness, investigative journalism*

Methods: In-depth interviews; qualitative content analysis; discourse analysis; computational content analysis; survey research; mixed methods

EDUCATION

PhD in Information and Media, Concentration: Journalism (ABD) Expected: Summer 2027

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

Dissertation: “Journalism as Negotiation: Roles, Norms, and Values in Everyday Practice”

Advisor: Tim P. Vos, Ph.D.

Committee: William Donohue, Ph.D.; Perry Parks, Ph.D.; Marisa Smith, Ph.D.

Master of Science, Journalism and Media Communication 2023

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

Master of Social Science, Mass Communication and Journalism 2013

University of Dhaka, Dhaka, Bangladesh

Bachelor of Social Science, Mass Communication and Journalism 2012

University of Dhaka, Dhaka, Bangladesh

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles — Published

- Zayeef, A., & Parks, P. (2026). Naturalizing Violence: Media Discourse and the Limits of Journalistic Nationalism. *Journalism Studies*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1461670X.2026.2695130>
- Zayeef, A., & Vos, T. P. (2025). Authoritarian influences: Interactivity within the hierarchy of influences model. *Journalism Studies*, 1–21. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1461670x.2025.2601234>

Accepted

- Zayeef, A., & Vos, T. P. (Accepted). Proximity and principle: Role and norm negotiation based on embeddedness of journalists. *Journalism Practice*.

Revise & Resubmit

- Parks, P., Zayeef, A., Pettengill, J., & Brown, K. D. (In revision). “We’re journalists, not advocates”: Advocacy and strategic ambiguity in U.S. metajournalistic discourse. *Journal of Media Ethics*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Accepted for Presentation

- [8] Zayeef, A., & Vos, T. P. (2026, August 5). The demystification mandate: Role, boundary, and embeddedness in the metajournalistic discourse of foreign correspondents in the United States. International Communication Division. 2026 AEJMC Annual Conference, New Orleans, LA.

- [7] Parks, P., Pettengill, J., **Zayeeef, A.**, Brown, K. D. (August 7). "We're Journalists, Not Advocates": Advocacy and Strategic Ambiguity in U.S. Metajournalistic Discourse. Cultural and Critical Studies Division. 2026 AEJMC Annual Conference, New Orleans, LA.

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers and Presentations

- [6] **Zayeeef, A** & Vos, T.P. (2025, August 7–10). Proximity and principle: Role and norm negotiation among embedded journalists. Community Journalism Interest Group. 2025 AEJMC Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.
- [5] Marple, C., Kim, M., Wang, Y., Delle, F., **Zayeeef, A.**, & Rhodes, N. (2025, June 14). Communication of story world norms in *The Devil Wears Prada*: A qualitative exploration. Mass Communication Division. 2025 ICA Annual Conference, Denver, CO.
- [4] **Zayeeef, A.**, Wolfgang, D. (2023, July 11). "Symbol of pride": Subjugation of journalism under power. 2023 IAMCR Annual Conference, Lyon, France.
- [3] **Zayeeef, A.**, Wolfgang, D. (2023, February 24). Propaganda of press freedom. Political Communication Division. AEJMC Midwinter Conference, Norman, OK.
- [2] **Zayeeef, A.** (2023, April 13). Maneuvering the DSA: Bangladeshi digital activists' ways of expression on Facebook. 2023 World Social Science Association Conference, Tempe, AZ.
- [1] **Zayeeef, A.**, Kodrich, K. (2023, April 14). Used and underpaid: A PEC analysis of the journalism profession in Bangladesh. 2023 World Social Science Association Conference, Tempe, AZ.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Michigan State University, School of Journalism

August 2024–Present

JRN 200: News Reporting and Writing

Core skills course in news judgment, information gathering, interviewing, and writing across platforms in AP style. Redesigned the syllabus; developed all lectures, assignments, and rubrics; evaluated student performance.

JRN 345: Images and Messages

Summer 2026

Asynchronous course on the critical, historical, and ethical study of visual communication in news and documentary contexts. Built the full course, including syllabus, video lectures, assignments, and rubrics; evaluated student performance.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Michigan State University, School of Journalism

August 2023–May 2024

JRN 108: The World of Media

Introductory survey of journalism and media industries, audiences, law, ethics, and media literacy. Facilitated a 350-student course; conducted weekly grading and assessment.

Colorado State University, Department of Journalism and Media Communication

August 2021–May 2023

JTC 100: Media in Society

Introductory course on the historical, economic, and cultural impact of mass media. Facilitated course sections; conducted weekly grading and assessment.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Grant Writing

Write Winning Grants (two-part seminar on competitive grant proposal writing)MSU Office of Research and Innovation, 2024

Research Integrity and Responsible Conduct of Research (RCR)

Ethics in Research and Creative Activity, and Effective Mentoring	2024–2025
Research Collaborations and Student Conflicts of Interest	2025
RCR Rigor and Reproducibility	2024
Research Practices, Teamwork and Conflict Resolution	2024

Case Studies in Mentoring	2024
Plagiarism; Authorship; Research Misconduct; Intellectual Property and Export Controls	2024
Use of Human Subjects and IRB; Record Keeping, Data Management, and Sharing of Information	2023–2024
CITI Program: Collaborative Research; Conflicts of Interest; Data Management; Financial Responsibility; Mentoring and Healthy Research Environments; Peer Review (RCR-Basic)	CITI Program, 2024–2025

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

DEI Foundations	2024
Sexual Assault Prevention for Graduate Students	2023, 2025

Campus Safety and Compliance

Cybersecurity Awareness	2025
Active Violence Incident (AVI) Awareness; FERPA for Employees; Ethics and Regulations in Human Research; Overview of Human Research Protection	2023

ACADEMIC AWARDS & HONORS

Top Paper Award (Faculty, 3rd), Cultural and Critical Studies Division	2026
Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC) <i>“We’re Journalists, Not Advocates”: Advocacy and Strategic Ambiguity in U.S. Metajournalistic Discourse</i>	
Best Student Paper Award, Community Journalism Interest Group	2025
Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC) <i>“Proximity and Principle: Role and Norm Negotiation Among Embedded Journalists”</i>	
Top Student Paper, Runner-Up, Mass Communication Division	2025
International Communication Association (ICA) <i>“Communication of Story World Norms in The Devil Wears Prada: A Qualitative Exploration”</i>	
Certificate of Academic Excellence	2022
National Residence Hall Honorary (NRHH), CSU Rams Chapter	

ACADEMIC SCHOLARSHIPS & FELLOWSHIPS

AEJMC-MSCD Diversity and Inclusion Career Development Fellow, \$1200	2026–2027
Dr. Delia Koo Global Student Scholarship, Michigan State University, \$2000	2026
Ellen L. and Clyde L. Burton Endowed Scholarship in Journalism, Michigan State University \$3200, \$1500, \$1470	2026, 2025, 2024
College of Communication Arts & Sciences Endowed Scholarship, Michigan State University, \$1000, \$1000	2026, 2025
Thorson Doctoral Research Fellowship, Michigan State University, \$2000	2025
Rasmussen Fellowship, Michigan State University, \$5000	2024
ComArtSci General Scholarship, Michigan State University, \$1000	2024

GRANTS

Professional Development Fund Award — \$1,375	2022
Department of Journalism and Media Communication, Colorado State University Supported attendance at the Investigative Reporters and Editors (IRE) Annual Conference, Denver, CO, June 2022	

SERVICE

Service to the Profession

Journalism Studies — Ad Hoc Reviewer	2024–Present
Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC) — Annual Conference Reviewer	2024–Present
Service to Department and University	
MSU Council of Graduate Students (COGS) — Departmental Representative, Journalism	2023–2025
University Council — COGS Representative	2024–2025
Association for Doctoral Students in Information & Media (ADSCIM) — Departmental Representative	2022–Present
MSU International Student Association — Co-Director of Outreach	2024–2025
Graduate Student Council (GSC), Colorado State University — Departmental Representative	2021–2022
Dhaka University Journalists Association (DUJA) — General Secretary (led 44 student journalists)	2012–2013

SKILLS

Research Methods: Qualitative content analysis; in-depth interviewing; discourse analysis; survey design and analysis; computational content analysis; mixed methods

Software: NVivo; Taguette; SPSS; Atlas.ti; Microsoft Office Suite

Languages: English (proficient); Bengali (native); Hindi (comprehension); Arabic (reading)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Reporter, The Daily Prothom Alo — Dhaka, Bangladesh March 2016–May 2021

Bangladesh's largest-circulation daily newspaper

Conducted high-stakes investigative reporting for Bangladesh's largest-circulation daily, covering national security, law enforcement accountability, state corruption, national election and terrorism. Work recognized with multiple national and international awards.

Reporter, The Daily Dhaka Tribune — Dhaka, Bangladesh February 2014–February 2015

Conducted investigative and policy reporting for an English-language national daily, covering governance, environment, and higher education.

University Correspondent, The Daily Prothom Alo — Dhaka, Bangladesh February 2010–January 2014

Covered institutional accountability and campus affairs at the University of Dhaka for a national daily.

University Correspondent, The Daily Sangbad — Dhaka, Bangladesh February 2009–January 2010

PROFESSIONAL AWARDS & RECOGNITION

National

Investigative Journalism Award 2021

Transparency International Bangladesh (TIB)

Best Investigative Reporter Award 2019

Crime Reporters Association of Bangladesh (CRAB)

Best Investigative Reporter Award 2019

The Daily Prothom Alo

Best Emerging Reporter Award 2018

The Daily Prothom Alo

International

Best Investigative Report from Bangladesh 2020

Global Investigative Journalism Network (GIJN)

Best Investigative Report from Bangladesh 2019

Global Investigative Journalism Network (GIJN)

Chevening South Asia Journalism Programme (SAJP) Fellow 2021

University of Westminster, London, UK — Awarded by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office

International Visitor Leadership Program (IVLP) Fellow February–March 2020

U.S. State Department — Edward R. Murrow Program for Journalists: Research and Investigation

Selective U.S. State Department program for international journalists; engaged with leading U.S. media organizations and attended professional development workshops on investigative reporting and disinformation.

Global Investigative Journalism Network (GIJN) Fellow

2019

GIJN Annual International Conference, Hamburg, Germany

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Allen Neighborhood Center — Weekly food distribution volunteer	August 2024–Present
American Red Cross — Blood donor and volunteer	October 2023–Present

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Investigative Reporters and Editors (IRE)	June 2022–Present
South Asian Journalists Association (SAJA)	October 2022–Present
Dhaka Reporters' Association (DRU)	June 2017–Present
Crime Reporters Association of Bangladesh (CRAB)	June 2017–Present

REFERENCES

Tim P. Vos, Ph.D.

Dissertation Chair

Director, School of Journalism

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

Email: tpvos@msu.edu

William Donohue, Ph.D.

Dissertation Committee Member

Department of Communication

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

Email: donohue@msu.edu

Perry Parks, Ph.D.

Dissertation Committee Member; Co-Author

School of Journalism

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

Email: parksp@msu.edu

Marisa Smith, Ph.D.

Dissertation Committee Member

Department of Advertising and Public Relations

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

Email: smit3330@msu.edu

David Wolfgang, PhD

Master's Thesis Advisor

Department of Journalism & Media Communication

Associate Professor

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

Email: david.wolfgang@colostate.edu